HEALING WORD (5E, 2024 RULES) – DESCRIPTION

Level 1 – Abjuration
Casting Time: **Bonus Action** · Range: 60 feet
Components: V · Duration: Instantaneous
Classes: Bard, Cleric, Druid

A creature of your choice that you can see within range regains a number of Hit Points equal to **2d4 + your spellcasting ability modifier**.

Higher-level slot: the healing increases by 2d4 for each slot level above 1.

🎲 Quick summary:

1. You choose a visible creature within 60 ft.
2. Bonus Action, Verbal component only.
3. It regains 2d4 + spellcasting ability modifier HP.
4. A creature at 0 HP stands up.

⚠ Flaw in the rule and fixes Table rule

The spell is a Bonus Action: it falls under the Bonus Action spell rule (only one spell per turn, except a cantrip). Fix: announce the rule before the game.

💡 Narrative option: Table rule

The DM can describe a breath of light, a murmured word that closes the wounds.

Step 1 – Choose the target:

A visible creature within 60 ft.

Step 2 – Cast:

Bonus Action, V component. You spend a level 1 or higher slot.

Step 3 – Healing:

2d4 + your spellcasting ability modifier HP.

Step 4 – At 0 HP:

A creature at 0 HP that regains HP regains consciousness (see the **HP, Healing and Dying** sheet).

Example: Hugo (Cleric, Wisdom +3) casts Healing Word on the archer at 0 HP: 2d4 = 5, + 3 = 8 HP. The archer stands up with 8 HP.

HEALING WORD (5E, 2024 RULES) – Q&A AND DEBATE

⚠ Common questions:

How much does it heal?
2d4 + spellcasting ability modifier.

What is the range?
60 ft.

Must I see the target?
Yes.

What action?
A Bonus Action.

Can I heal an ally at 0 HP?
Yes: they regain HP and consciousness.

Can I cast another spell this turn?
Only an action cantrip, under the Bonus Action spell rule.

Do I need to speak?
Yes: Verbal component.

Does it scale?
Yes: +2d4 per slot level above 1.

⚠ Debate points and table options:

Table rule

The “yo-yo”
Standing up an ally at 0 HP with few HP encourages healing then letting them drop again. **Option**: keep it; or a raised ally stays prone for a turn.

Bonus Action spell rule
After a Bonus Action spell, only an action cantrip can be cast. **Option**: apply the rule as written.

Remote healing
The spell allows healing without entering melee. **Option**: the DM may require a line of sight.

Silence
The component is verbal: the spell is impossible under *Silence*. **Option**: follow the text.

⚠ Rule clarifications (answers found on the web, reworded):

One Bonus Action spell
Action and Bonus Action can’t be swapped: a Bard can use Bardic Inspiration or Healing Word with the turn’s Bonus Action, not both.

Paired cantrip
Healing Word (Bonus Action) and a one-action cantrip (such as Vicious Mockery) are possible on the same turn, because the cantrip uses no slot.

These points remain open to discussion: your feedback is welcome to refine this sheet.

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